

Department of Mathematics and Applied Mathematics
Module 3MS: Metric Spaces 2024

Class test 1 solutions

Total Marks: 40

1. Let d_E be the Euclidean metric on $\mathbb{R}$ and d_D the discrete metric on $\mathbb{R}$.
Let $A = \{-1\} \cup (0, 4) \cup (4, 7]$.

(a) $\text{int}(A) = (0, 4) \cup (4, 7)$.

(b) $\overline{A} = \{-1\} \cup [0, 7]$.

(c) $\text{bd}(A) = \{-1, 0, 4, 7\}$.

(d) $\text{int}(A) = A$.

[4]

2. Suppose (X, d) is a metric space. Define ρ by:

$$\rho(x, y) = \min\{1, d(x, y)\} \text{ for all } x, y \in X$$

- (a) For $x, y, z \in X$:

Clearly $\rho(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}$.

(M1) $\rho(x, x) = \min\{1, d(x, x)\} = 0$ since $d(x, x) = 0$. Conversely,
if $\rho(x, y) = 0$, then $\min\{1, d(x, y)\} = 0$, so $d(x, y) = 0$ and then $x = y$.

(M2) $\rho(x, y) = \min\{1, d(x, y)\} = \min\{1, d(y, x)\} = \rho(y, x)$.

(M3) We show $\rho(x, z) \leq \rho(x, y) + \rho(y, z)$.

Case 1: If $\rho(x, y) = 1$ or $\rho(y, z) = 1$ (or both), then $\rho(x, z) \leq \rho(x, y) + \rho(y, z)$,
because $\rho(x, z) \leq 1$ and $\rho(x, y) \geq 0$ and $\rho(y, z) \geq 0$.

Case 2: Otherwise, $\rho(x, y) = d(x, y)$ and $\rho(y, z) = d(y, z)$.

So $\rho(x, z) \leq d(x, z) \leq d(x, y) + d(y, z) = \rho(x, y) + \rho(y, z)$.

(b) $B(0; \frac{1}{2024}) = (-\frac{1}{2024}, \frac{1}{2024})$

(c) $B(0; 2024) = \mathbb{R}$

[8]

3. (a) True.

Let (X, d) be a metric space, for A, B subsets of X , we have $A \subseteq A \cup B$ and $B \subseteq A \cup B$, therefore $\overline{A} \subseteq \overline{A \cup B}$ and $\overline{B} \subseteq \overline{A \cup B}$, from which we have $\overline{A} \cup \overline{B} \subseteq \overline{A \cup B}$. Now, let $x \in \overline{A \cup B}$, then there exists a sequence (x_n) in $A \cup B$ such that $x_n \rightarrow x$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$, we then have that either A or B contain infinitely many elements of sequence (x_n) , suppose without loss of generality that it is A , then we have that A contains a subsequence (x_{n_k}) of (x_n) and $x_{n_k} \rightarrow x$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$ and so $x \in \overline{A} \subseteq \overline{A} \cup \overline{B}$.

(b) False.

Consider $(\mathbb{R}, d_E)$. Let $A = (0, 4]$ and $B = [4, 7)$, we have $\text{int}(A \cup B) = (0, 7)$ while $\text{int}(A) \cup \text{int}(B) = (0, 4) \cup (4, 7)$.

(c) False.

Consider $(\mathbb{R}, d_E)$. Let $A = \mathbb{Q}$, we have $\overline{A} = \mathbb{R}$ and so $\text{int}(\overline{A}) = \mathbb{R}$ while $\text{int}(A) = \emptyset$.

(d) False.

Consider $(\mathbb{R}, d_E)$. Let $A = \mathbb{Q}$, we have $\text{bd}(A) = \mathbb{R}$ while $\text{bd}(\text{bd}(A)) = \text{bd}(\mathbb{R}) = \emptyset$.

[3+3+3+3=12]

4. (a) For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, apply the condition in line (3) using $r = \frac{1}{n}$. Since $B(a, \frac{1}{n}) \not\subseteq A$, there exists an element x_n of $B(a, \frac{1}{n})$ that is not in A .

(b) For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $0 \leq d(x_n, a) < \frac{1}{n}$, since $x_n \in B(a, \frac{1}{n})$. Taking limits as $n \rightarrow \infty$ gives $d(x_n, a) \rightarrow 0$, i.e. $x_n \rightarrow a$.

(c) In line (4) we chose $x_n \notin A$, so $x_n \in A'$.

(d) By assumption, A' is closed. Since x_n is a sequence in A' and $x_n \rightarrow a$, $a \in A'$ also.

(e) In line (7) $a \in A'$, but in line (3), $a \in A$.

[3+3+2+2+2=12]

5. (a) False.

Consider $(\mathbb{R}, d_E)$. We have $d_E^2(1, 3) = 2^2 = 4$, but $d_E^2(1, 2) + d_E^2(2, 3) = 1^2 + 1^2 = 2$, so the triangle inequality fails.

(b) It is clear that $F \subseteq \bigcap \{K \in P(X) \mid K \text{ is a closed subset of } X \text{ and } F \ll K\}$, because $F \ll K$ implies that $F \subseteq K$.

For the other inclusion, we show that if $x \notin F$, then

$x \notin \bigcap \{K \in P(X) \mid K \text{ is a closed subset of } X \text{ and } F \ll K\}$.

So suppose that F is a closed subset of X and $x \notin F$.

Then $d(x, F) = \inf\{d(x, y) \mid y \in F\} = r > 0$.

Let $K = \{z \in X : d(x, z) \geq \frac{r}{2}\}$.

Then $x \notin K$.

Note that K is closed, since it is the complement of an open ball.

Let $H = B[x, \frac{r}{2}]$.

Then $F \cap H = \emptyset$ since if $a \in H \cap F$, then $r = \text{dist}(x, F) \leq d(a, x) \leq \frac{r}{2}$; contradiction.

We also have $H \cup K = X$, since, for all $a \in X$, $d(a, x) \geq \frac{r}{2}$ or $d(a, x) \leq \frac{r}{2}$.
[2+2=4]